

Chapter

Growth of Nationalism

1. Tahir is preparing to give a speech about the Sati system in India. Which of the following Indian leader's contribution MUST he mention in his speech?

- | | |
|-----------------------|--------------------|
| (a) Raja Rammohan Roy | (b) W. C. Bonerjee |
| (c) Bipin Chandra Pal | (d) Jyotiba Phule |

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2. The aimed to introduce equality between British and Indian Judges.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------|
| (a) Vernacular Press Act | (b) Gagging Act |
| (c) Indian Universities Act | (d) Ilbert Bill |

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3. During the Great Revolt of 1857 some patriotic Indians played prominent role in this fight against the British. State briefly the role of each of the following :

- (i) Nana Saheb**
- (ii) The Rani of Jhansi**
- (iii) Tantia Tope.**

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4. The initial success of the Uprising of 1857, the objective of the leaders of the Uprising included

- (a) Restoring the former glory to the Mughal empire;
- (b) Forming a federation of Indian States under the aegis of Bhadur Shah II;
- (c) Eliminating foreign rule and return of the old order;
- (d) Establishing his own power in his respective region by each leader.

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5. Name the Act that transferred the Government of India from the Company to the Crown. When was it passed ?

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6. Economic exploitation of the country produced discontent, resentment and resistance among the people that culminated in the Great Uprising of 1857. Examine this factor with reference to the following :

(i) The ruin of trade and handicrafts.

(ii) Impoverishment of the cultivators.

(iii) Subordination of Indian economy to British interests (Making India an Agricultural Colony of British capitalism.

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7. Mention any two repressive policies of Lord Lytton.

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8. 'Although the Revolt of 1857 failed, but it had important consequences for India'. In this context answer the following questions :

(i) How did the Revolt give rise to nationalism in India?

(ii) How did the end of the East India Company bring in grave economic perils in India?

(iii) How did the British Government try to pacify the feelings of Indians with regard to :

(a) Their religious practices.

(b) The princely states.

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9. There were many causes for the uprising of 1857. In this context, state the following :

(i) Policy of economic exploitation.

(ii) Racial discrimination.

(iii) Social Causes.

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Solution

1.

Ans: (a) Raja Rammohan Roy

Explanation:

Raja Rammohan Roy played a major role in **abolishing the practice of Sati** in India. He strongly opposed this inhuman custom and persuaded the British government to ban it.

Thus, the correct option is **(a)**.

2.

Ans: (d) Ilbert Bill

Explanation:

The **Ilbert Bill** was introduced to allow **Indian judges to try European offenders**, thereby aiming to establish **equality between Indian and British judges** in courts.

Thus, the correct option is **(d)**.

3.

Ans:

(i) Nana Saheb

Nana Saheb, the adopted son of Peshwa Baji Rao II, was a leading figure in the revolt at Kanpur. He rose in rebellion against the British and successfully seized control of Kanpur. Declaring himself the Peshwa, he inspired people to join the fight against British rule. His bold leadership and refusal to accept British authority made him a key personality in the Revolt of 1857.

(ii) The Rani of Jhansi

Rani Lakshmi Bai, popularly remembered as the Rani of Jhansi, was one of the most famous leaders of the Revolt. When the British annexed Jhansi under the Doctrine of Lapse, she took up arms to defend her kingdom. She displayed exceptional courage and military skill, fighting fiercely against the British. Her heroic defence of Jhansi and her valiant actions during the retreat to Gwalior

made her a powerful symbol of bravery and an enduring icon of India's struggle for freedom.

(iii) Tantia Tope

Tantia Tope was a trusted general of Nana Saheb. He played an important part in many battles in Central India, especially in the recapture of Kanpur. Known for his guerrilla warfare tactics, he led several campaigns that kept the British forces engaged for a long time. Although eventually defeated, his determination and fighting skills made him one of the most respected leaders of the revolt.

4.

Ans: (c) Eliminating foreign rule and return of the old order

Explanation:

After the early success of the **Uprising of 1857**, the leaders aimed to **end British rule** in India and restore the **traditional political system** that existed before foreign domination. Their main objective was to remove British authority and bring back the old order.

Thus, the correct option is **(c)**.

5.

Ans: The Act that transferred the Government of India from the Company to the Crown was the **Act for the Better Government of India**.

It was passed on **August 2, 1858**.

6.

Ans:

(i) Ruin of trade and handicrafts:

The British deliberately destroyed India's thriving textile industry to promote British goods.

They imposed **heavy tariffs on Indian textiles in England**, while allowing **British goods to enter India with low duties**.

As a result, important manufacturing centres like **Dhaka, Murshidabad and Surat** declined, leading to unemployment and poverty.

This economic hardship contributed to the growing discontent that led to the Revolt of 1857.

(ii) Impoverishment of the cultivators:

British land-revenue systems such as the **Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari and Mahalwari** placed a heavy burden on cultivators.

A major part of the produce was taken as revenue, leaving farmers very poor. Frequent **famines**, along with high revenue demands, forced peasants into **debt with moneylenders**.

This extreme poverty created resentment against the British rule.

(iii) Subordination of the Indian economy to British interests:

The British shaped India's economy to serve **their own industrial and commercial interests**.

Heavy taxes were imposed on Indian textiles, while **raw materials were exported to Britain and finished goods were imported into India**.

This turned India into an **agricultural colony**, with its trade and economy controlled by the British, causing further economic decline and discontent.

7.

Ans:

(i) Vernacular Press Act (1878): This Act censored **vernacular newspapers**, suppressing freedom of the press and preventing the spread of nationalist ideas.

(ii) Arms Act (1878): This Act prevented Indians from **owning firearms without a licence**, while Europeans were exempt. It aimed to keep weapons out of Indian hands and strengthen British control.

8.

Ans:

(i) (a) The Revolt created a strong sense of unity among **Hindus and Muslims**, who fought together against British rule.

(b) The sacrifices made by the leaders of 1857 **inspired future nationalist movements**.

(c) For the first time, Indians came together with a **common aim—to overthrow British rule**, which laid the foundation for Indian nationalism.

(ii) (a) **Economic Exploitation:** The end of Company rule led to direct British governance, which resulted in high salaries for officials and increased economic pressure on India.

(b) **Agricultural Distortion and Taxation:** Farmers were forced to grow **cash crops** for British industries, causing food shortages. Heavy taxes and unfair trade practices made their situation worse.

(c) **Financial Drain:** British investment in railways and plantations came with heavy **interest and dividend payments**, which drained India's wealth and increased poverty.

(iii) (a) **Their religious practices:** The **Queen's Proclamation of 1858** promised that the British would **not interfere** in Indian religious beliefs and customs, ensuring **religious freedom**.

(b) **The princely states:** The British **abolished the Doctrine of Lapse** and allowed Indian rulers to adopt heirs. They assured princes that their territories would **not be annexed**, and existing treaties would be respected.

9.

Ans:

(i) **Policy of economic exploitation:**

British land-revenue systems like the **Zamindari, Ryotwari and Mahalwari** impoverished farmers. They were forced to sell their produce at low prices to pay revenue and satisfy moneylenders.

India was turned from a **self-sufficient economy into an agricultural colony**, exporting raw materials and importing expensive British goods.

Indian handicrafts were ruined and millions of people lived in poverty.

(ii) **Racial discrimination:**

The British considered themselves **racially superior** and treated Indians as inferior.

Indians faced **insults, segregation and unequal treatment**, especially in public places, offices and the military.

This humiliation created deep resentment among Indians and fuelled anti-British feelings.

(iii) Social causes:

The British introduced social reforms like the **abolition of Sati (1829)** and **Widow Remarriage Act (1856)** without considering Indian sentiments.

Many people viewed these reforms as an **interference in religious and cultural practices**, leading to widespread dissatisfaction.

As a result, these reforms were met with suspicion and resistance.